# CORSA Jakarta: Market Entry, Business Case & Future Innovation

## HSG Capstone Project Scope:

**Build the strategic and financial foundation for CORSA's first international flagship in Jakarta.**

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## 1. Project Background

CORSA is a young food and lifestyle brand born in Zurich. It combines Italian racing heritage, healthy Mediterranean food, specialty coffee, functional drinks, performance culture and community into one scalable brand system.

The brand is not positioned as a traditional café or restaurant. CORSA is built as a lifestyle-driven food concept for people who move — physically, professionally and culturally. Its core promise is simple: food and coffee as fuel, wrapped in a strong emotional and visual world.

The first CORSA pop-up at Zurich HB served as the first real-market validation of the concept. CORSA was operated in a high-frequency, highly competitive location and generated practical learnings across product, pricing, customer behaviour, staffing, operations, branding and daily execution. The existing company materials position CORSA as "a next-generation food and lifestyle brand designed for people who move," combining pasta, specialty coffee and functional drinks into one scalable system.

The Zurich pop-up also delivered clear early traction: over 200,000 people reached, a 4.9-star Google rating and ROI reached after a three-month pop-up at Zurich HB. These proof

points are important because the Capstone Project should not treat CORSA as an abstract idea, but as an operating early-stage brand preparing its next strategic location.

The next intended step is Jakarta, Indonesia, as CORSA's first international flagship location.

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## 2. Why Jakarta

Jakarta is the selected strategic direction, but the underlying assumptions must be tested.

The project should therefore not answer whether CORSA should generally internationalize. The international ambition is already part of the company direction. Jakarta is the current strategic focus because of its scale, young urban population, growing middle class, high eating frequency, rising café culture, increasing interest in fitness and performance lifestyles, and its potential as a gateway market in Southeast Asia.

The existing Jakarta material frames the city as "the pulse of a nation in constant motion" and describes it as a fast-paced metropolitan hub where tradition meets modernity. The same material defines Jakarta's market characteristics as young, urban and social, with high eating frequency, café culture as lifestyle, and a rising interest in fitness, performance and community.

However, choosing Jakarta as the strategic direction does not mean that all assumptions are correct. The Capstone Project should help CORSA understand which assumptions are strong, which are weak, which need adaptation, and which require further local validation.

Relevant assumptions include:

- whether CORSA's target customers exist in sufficient concentration;
- whether pricing can work in the local market;
- whether the product mix needs adaptation;
- whether the brand identity transfers culturally;
- whether location economics support profitability;
- whether the investment frame is realistic;
- whether the first flagship should be street-facing, mall-based or hybrid;
- whether community and ambassador-led growth can become a real advantage.

Jakarta should be compared briefly with Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong as benchmark markets. These cities should not be treated as equal strategic alternatives in the project. They should serve as reference points to sharpen the Jakarta logic and identify what makes Jakarta attractive, different or risky.

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# 3. Objective of the Capstone Project

The objective of the HSG Capstone Project is to create a focused, realistic and execution-oriented basis for CORSA's Jakarta market entry.

The central project question is:

**How can CORSA enter Jakarta as its first international flagship location in a commercially realistic, strategically coherent and culturally relevant way?**

The project should focus on three main pillars:

1. **Strategic Fit, including Competitor & Benchmark Map**
2. **Jakarta Financial Model & Business Case**
3. **Future Innovation, Food Tech & Physical AI**

The financial model and business case should be treated as the core deliverable of Phase 1. The strategic and cultural fit analysis should provide the logic behind the business case. Pillars 1 and 2 jointly include the 90-day validation and execution roadmap for CORSA after the project. These outputs should be ready for the interim presentation on 22 October 2026. Phase 2 then focuses on Pillar 3, Future Innovation, Food Tech & Physical AI, through the final presentation on 11 December 2026.

The six students work in two teams during Phase 1, covering strategic fit and the business case, with shared responsibility for the roadmap and evidence appendix. In Phase 2, they organise their work around the three innovation themes below. The students should agree responsibilities and research priorities with CORSA and review progress weekly.

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# 4. Scope Clarification: What HSG Should Do vs. What CORSA Will Do

To avoid an overly broad project, the Capstone scope must clearly separate what is expected from the students and what remains the responsibility of CORSA.

The students are not expected to build the entire international business from scratch. They are expected to help CORSA structure, test, calculate and improve the Jakarta entry logic.

### HSG / Student Scope

The HSG team should focus on:

- market and competitor research;
- benchmark analysis, including Oakberry as a mandatory but not dominant case study;
- strategic fit assessment for Jakarta;

- cultural fit assessment based on available evidence, interviews, proxies and benchmarks;
- location logic and location economics;
- Jakarta-specific financial modelling;
- assumptions testing;
- preparation and execution of selected interviews;
- preparation of questions for local experts and contacts;
- synthesis of risks, open questions and validation needs;
- creation of a 90-day roadmap within Pillars 1 and 2 for CORSA after project completion;

- research into future customer needs, food technology, production and delivery coordination, and kitchen automation feasibility;
- development of an innovation recommendation and a technical collaboration brief for a potential next-stage pilot.

## CORSA Internal Scope

CORSA will remain responsible for:

- final strategic decisions;
- investor conversations and negotiations;
- activating existing Jakarta contacts;
- direct business development with families, investors, actors, brokers, landlords, gastronomy entrepreneurs and local partners;
- final brand, design and product decisions;
- operational implementation;
- legal setup;
- location negotiations;
- Jakarta travel and on-site execution;
- final investor deck refinement and fundraising activities.

## Shared Interface

The following elements should be developed collaboratively:

- key assumptions list;
- interview questions;
- financial assumptions;
- location criteria;
- validation priorities;
- interpretation of findings;
- prioritization of next steps.

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# 5. Available Inputs from CORSA

CORSA can provide the students with relevant internal information and documentation.

Available inputs include:

- Zurich pop-up learnings;
- pop-up revenue and cost information;
- product performance insights;
- menu logic;
- pricing logic;
- operational learnings;
- brand identity and visual world;
- existing CORSA strategy materials;
- existing Jakarta concept material;
- existing investor and expansion assumptions;
- access to selected Jakarta-related contacts where appropriate.

The current investment assumption for Jakarta is approximately **CHF 200,000**. This should be treated as a working assumption that needs to be tested through the business case.

Existing Jakarta access includes certain families, two investors and well-known actors. Direct real estate or gastronomy entrepreneur contacts are not yet secured, but network access can be requested once the project has clarified the right strategic direction and contact priorities.

The students may speak with selected Jakarta contacts if CORSA releases those contacts during the project. Outreach does not need to be sent independently without alignment. The main task is to prepare the logic, questions and structure so that outreach can be effective and targeted.

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# 6. Project Pillar 1: Strategic Fit

### Including Competitor & Benchmark Map

The first pillar should answer whether the Jakarta entry logic is strategically sound and how CORSA should position itself in the local market.

This pillar should include interpretation. It should not remain at the level of generic country facts. It should help CORSA understand how Jakarta's consumer behaviour, urban lifestyle, food culture, café culture and premium lifestyle market relate to CORSA's concept.

### Key Questions

- Who are the most relevant CORSA customers in Jakarta?

- How strong is the fit with young urban professionals, upper-middle-class consumers, fitness communities, creators, students, expats and lifestyle-driven consumers?
- How do people in Jakarta use cafés and food spaces socially?
- What role do premium cafés, healthy food, coffee, social spaces and community-driven brands play in Jakarta?
- Which competitors or comparable concepts already exist?
- What can CORSA learn from local and international benchmarks?
- How does Jakarta compare briefly to Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong?
- Which cultural assumptions need to be tested before execution?
- Which parts of CORSA's concept are likely to transfer well?
- Which parts may need adaptation?

## Cultural Fit

Cultural fit is important, but it is difficult to fully validate remotely. The students should therefore not be expected to prove cultural fit with absolute certainty.

Instead, they should build a structured cultural fit assessment based on:

- desk research;
- benchmark cases;
- selected interviews if feasible;
- local expert input if accessible;
- Jakarta consumer proxies;
- creator and community behaviour;
- local food and café habits;
- comparison with other international food and lifestyle brands.

If possible, at least one person with Jakarta or Indonesia knowledge should be involved through an interview, expert conversation or informal validation session.

## Benchmarking

Oakberry should be included as a mandatory benchmark, but it should not dominate the project.

Oakberry is relevant because it shows how a simple product system, strong health positioning, strong visual identity and international expansion logic can be combined. The students should analyse what CORSA can learn from Oakberry's growth model, but also where CORSA should not copy it blindly.

Relevant benchmark questions:

- What made Oakberry scalable?

- How did Oakberry simplify the product?
- How did the brand translate internationally?
- What role did health, lifestyle and convenience play?
- What mistakes or risks should CORSA avoid?
- How does CORSA differ through Italian heritage, pasta, coffee, functional drinks and community?

Other benchmarks can include premium cafés, healthy food brands, functional food concepts, specialty coffee chains, lifestyle restaurants and community-led brands in Jakarta or comparable cities.

### Expected Output

This pillar should result in:

- strategic fit assessment for Jakarta;
- competitor and benchmark map;
- target customer overview;
- cultural fit considerations;
- brief comparison with Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong;
- clear strategic implications for CORSA.

Strategic findings should also define the customer, location and validation priorities for the joint 90-day roadmap prepared within Pillars 1 and 2 by 22 October 2026.

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## 7. Project Pillar 2: Jakarta Financial Model & Business Case

This is the core deliverable of Phase 1 and should be ready for the interim presentation on 22 October 2026.

The purpose is to build a realistic, Jakarta-specific financial model that helps CORSA understand whether the first flagship can work commercially and under which assumptions.

The current investment frame is approximately CHF 200,000. The students should test whether this is realistic and how the investment would need to be allocated.

### Key Questions

- What is the realistic investment requirement for a first CORSA flagship in Jakarta?
- Is CHF 200,000 foundercapital enough?
- Does the bank have to be involved?
- What are the main CAPEX blocks?

- What are the expected monthly operating costs?
- What rent levels are realistic for relevant districts?
- What staff structure is required?
- What salary assumptions should be used?
- What food cost and gross margin assumptions are realistic?
- What pricing could work in Jakarta?
- What daily revenue is needed to break even?
- What payback period is realistic?
- What does the business case look like in conservative, base and optimistic scenarios?
- What are the biggest financial risks?
- Which assumptions are most sensitive?

## CAPEX Components to Consider

- store build-out;
- kitchen equipment;
- coffee equipment;
- interior and furniture;
- branding and signage;
- POS and technology;
- pre-opening marketing;
- legal and administrative setup;
- licenses and permits;
- staff training;
- opening inventory;
- working capital;
- contingency reserve.

## OPEX Components to Consider

- rent;
- salaries;
- food cost;
- coffee cost;
- drinks and ingredients;
- packaging;
- utilities;
- maintenance;
- delivery platform fees if relevant;
- marketing;
- local management;
- accounting and administration;
- insurance;
- waste and logistics;
- miscellaneous operating costs.

## Revenue Components to Consider

- pasta;
- coffee;
- functional drinks;
- breakfast or snack products;
- add-ons;
- retail products;
- events;
- B2B partnerships;
- future merchandise potential.

## Location Economics

The existing Jakarta concept identifies the following target areas:

Tier 1:

- SCBD;
- Senopati;
- Kuningan.

Tier 2:

- Kemang;
- PIK.

The existing location direction is a flagship with presence and energy, approximately 120–180 sqm, ground floor, street visibility and a sit-down plus take-away setup.

The financial model should connect directly to location assumptions. Rent, footfall, ticket size, customer profile and operating format must be analysed together.

## Expected Output

This pillar should result in:

- Jakarta financial model;
- CAPEX and OPEX breakdown;
- revenue model;
- pricing assumptions;
- gross margin assumptions;
- break-even analysis;
- payback logic;

- conservative / base / optimistic scenario;
- key sensitivity analysis;
- location economics overview.

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## Joint Phase 1 90-Day Validation & Execution Roadmap

The 90-day roadmap is developed jointly within Pillars 1 and 2 and completed by 22 October 2026. It translates the strategic findings and business case into a practical action plan for CORSA after the Capstone Project ends. The 90 days describe CORSA's subsequent execution horizon.

The students are not expected to execute the full Jakarta entry. However, they should help CORSA understand what needs to happen next and in which order.

## Key Questions

- What should CORSA do in the first 90 days after the Capstone Project?
- Which assumptions need to be validated first?
- Which local experts should be contacted?
- Which broker, investor, ambassador, community or brand categories should be prioritized?
- What should the Jakarta trip focus on?
- Which meetings should be prepared?
- Which financial assumptions need on-site confirmation?
- Which location questions need local validation?
- Which decisions should be made before committing to a location?
- Which open risks remain?

## Roadmap Areas

The 90-day roadmap should include:

- validation priorities;
- local expert interviews;
- broker and real estate preparation;
- investor meeting preparation;
- ambassador and community mapping;
- possible brand or supplier conversations;
- Jakarta travel structure;
- location visit criteria;
- next financial data needed;
- decision points;

- risk controls.

# 8. Project Pillar 3: Future Innovation, Food Tech & Physical AI

Phase 2 runs from 22 October to 11 December 2026. Building on the market and financial work in Phase 1, the students should explore how CORSA could improve its B2C food offering and delivery experience through food technology, intelligent logistics and Physical AI.

CORSA's longer-term ambition includes a highly automated Jakarta flagship and coordinated production and delivery. The task is to assess where this ambition creates meaningful customer and operating value, which assumptions hold, and what deserves further development. CORSA Race Control is a working concept; its architecture, functions and partners remain open.

The students are encouraged to challenge CORSA's assumptions, identify opportunities beyond the initial ideas and form their own recommendations. They should prioritise a manageable set of use cases and explain why those matter. The scope is research, feasibility assessment and the definition of a potential technical collaboration and pilot.

## Key Questions

- How might customer needs and behaviours change, and which unmet needs should CORSA address first?
- Which food technology innovations could improve nutrition, affordability, meal quality or convenience in a way customers value?
- How could demand, preparation and delivery work together more effectively, and where would AI or automation add measurable value?
- Which kitchen activities could be automated in Jakarta, and where would people, local support or additional evidence remain necessary?
- Which options are feasible given data access, integration requirements, hygiene, reliability and the financial assumptions from Phase 1?
- What should CORSA test first, with whom, and what evidence would justify the next investment?

## Food Tech and Future Customer Needs

Investigate relevant food innovations and future consumption behaviours. Connect the research to CORSA's customers and positioning, including the meal experience, nutrition, price and quality after transport. Students should identify the opportunities they consider most relevant and explain how they could be tested.

## Food Logistics and Production Coordination

Explore how ordering, demand planning, cooking and dispatch could work together, including opportunities for autonomous coordination. Consider the data and system interfaces required and the effect on waiting times, waste and cost per order. Use the Jakarta business case to assess the operational and financial implications.

## Physical AI and Kitchen Automation

Assess how sensing, AI and robotic or automated equipment could support physical kitchen operations. Compare relevant approaches, their local feasibility and the role of people in replenishment, cleaning, quality control and exceptions. Consider build-or-buy choices, vendor support and potential technical partners without assuming a particular solution is already selected.

## Research Approach

The team should choose appropriate methods, using available research, benchmarks and selected expert or supplier conversations coordinated with CORSA. Compare promising ideas with a practical operating baseline, distinguish evidence from assumptions and explain important uncertainties. A simple process model, simulation or concept prototype may help where it answers a specific question; a deployed AI system or robotic kitchen is not required within the Capstone.

## Expected Output

- A prioritised innovation recommendation linking future customer needs to promising food tech, logistics and Physical AI opportunities.
- A feasibility comparison of the selected options, including expected customer benefit, operational requirements, cost implications and evidence gaps.
- A recommended B2C use case and pilot concept with a testable hypothesis, baseline, required data and suitable measures of success.
- A technical collaboration brief defining potential HSG, CORSA and engineering or technology partner roles, interfaces, data and IP questions, resources, indicative budget and next steps. Any implementation commitments require agreement with the relevant partners.
- The implications of the innovation recommendation for the Jakarta business case and the next steps CORSA should take.

The team may choose the most useful format for its analysis. The final recommendation should make clear what CORSA should pursue, what it should defer and which assumptions still need testing.

# 9. Final Deliverables

To keep the project focused, the final output should consist of four integrated deliverables developed across the two project phases.

### 1. Integrated Jakarta Market Entry Recommendation

This is the main report or deck. It should answer the core strategic question and include the most important insights from strategic fit, market logic, cultural fit, competitors, benchmarks and location logic.

This Phase 1 recommendation should be ready by 22 October 2026 and contribute the strategic priorities to the joint 90-day validation and execution roadmap.

### 2. Jakarta Business Case

This includes the financial model, investment logic, operating assumptions, pricing assumptions, location economics, scenarios, break-even and payback.

This is the core Phase 1 deliverable, ready by 22 October 2026. Together with the market entry recommendation, it includes the 90-day validation and execution roadmap for CORSA after the Capstone Project. Phase 2 should identify any changes to the business case arising from the innovation assessment.

### 3. Evidence & Validation Appendix

This includes sources, benchmark notes, interview summaries, assumptions, open risks, uncertainty levels and data gaps.

The purpose is to distinguish clearly between what is known, what is estimated and what still needs to be validated.

The appendix should be maintained throughout both phases, with the Phase 1 evidence and open questions documented by 22 October 2026.

### 4. Future Innovation, Food Tech & Physical AI Recommendation

This Phase 2 deliverable brings together the innovation opportunities, feasibility assessment and recommended B2C use case or pilot, based on the students' own research and prioritisation.

It includes a technical collaboration brief outlining potential partners and roles, data and interface requirements, resources, budget assumptions and the next decisions needed. It should be ready for the final presentation on 11 December 2026.

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# 10. Working Principles

## Focus Over Breadth

The project should go deeper into a few important questions rather than touch too many topics superficially.

## Assumptions Must Be Tested

Jakarta is the selected strategic direction, but the assumptions behind Jakarta must be tested.

## Core Brand Identity Is Non-Negotiable

CORSA's core identity should remain protected.

Non-negotiable elements include:

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- healthy Mediterranean food;
- specialty coffee;
- functional drinks;
- racing culture;
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- premium positioning;
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## Market Entry Assumptions Are Adaptable

The following elements may be adapted:

- menu details;
- pricing;
- store size;
- location type;
- day/night balance;
- launch sequence;
- local collaborations;
- communication nuances;
- ambassador approach;
- community activation.

### Learning Cycles Must Be Fast

The project should move through quick learning cycles. Speed matters in how quickly assumptions are tested and improved.

### Execution Must Be Disciplined

The final recommendation should not simply be creative or optimistic. It must be commercially disciplined and grounded in evidence, benchmarks and transparent assumptions.

### Reality Over Theory

The students should connect their work to real numbers, real consumer behaviour, real location economics and real execution constraints wherever possible.

Where real data is unavailable, they should use proxies, benchmarks and assumptions — but clearly label them as such.

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## 11. Suggested Timeline

### 17 and 23 September 2026

HSG course kick-off on 17 September, followed by the CORSA team kick-off on 23 September. Confirm the two Phase 1 teams, inputs, responsibilities and the updated scope.

### 30 September 2026

Submit the project proposal to CORSA and the lecturer by 18:00 for approval, including the accelerated Phase 1 outputs and the Phase 2 innovation scope.

### 9 October 2026

Internal review of the market entry recommendation, financial model, draft roadmap and evidence gaps.

### 22 October 2026

Interim presentation, 08:00-12:00, with a 12-15-minute presentation. Complete Pillars 1 and 2, including the joint 90-day roadmap and Phase 1 evidence appendix. Agree priorities for the transition to Pillar 3.

### 22 October to 12 November 2026

Research future customer needs, food technology, production and delivery coordination, and Physical AI. Discuss initial findings and research priorities with CORSA on 12 November.

### 26 November 2026

Review the innovation recommendation, feasibility findings and draft technical collaboration brief. Refine the proposed pilot and its implications for the business case.

### Before the final presentation

Submit the integrated final report of 20-30 pages, with an appendix where appropriate, and the project communication deliverable, such as a 1-3-minute video. Complete Rflect requirements throughout the course.

### 11 December 2026

Final presentation, 08:00-13:00, with a 20-25-minute presentation, and handover of the complete business and innovation work. The 9 October, 12 November and 26 November reviews are internal project checkpoints, alongside weekly CORSA reviews.

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## 12. Success Definition

The Capstone Project is successful if CORSA has a focused and realistic market entry basis, including the joint 90-day roadmap, by 22 October 2026, followed by an evidence-based innovation recommendation and technical collaboration brief by 11 December 2026.

Success means that CORSA can answer:

- Why Jakarta?
- Which assumptions are strong?
- Which assumptions remain uncertain?
- Which target customers matter most?
- Which competitors and benchmarks are relevant?
- Which location logic should guide the search?
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- What revenue level is needed?
- What cost structure is expected?
- What pricing could work?
- What are the biggest risks?
- What should CORSA validate in the next 90 days?
- How should the Jakarta trip be prepared?
- Which contacts should be activated first?

- Which future customer needs and innovation opportunities should CORSA prioritise?
- Which food tech, logistics and Physical AI options merit further development, and on what evidence?
- Which technical collaboration and pilot should CORSA pursue next?

## 13. Closing Statement

CORSA's first Zurich pop-up showed early traction. This project turns that momentum into a clear plan for Jakarta: test assumptions, strengthen the business case and define the next 90 days of action.

Phase two explores how food tech, logistics and Physical AI can support customer needs and business goals.

**The goal: build a solid foundation for CORSA's first international flagship in Jakarta.**